

Interview Guide: Attendance Management Research

Design Thinking Project — Empathise Stage

Interviewer(s): Carlito De Almeida **Date:** _____

Participant Role: ☐ Student [] Lecturer [] Administrative Staff

Participant Code: _____ (e.g., Student A, Lecturer B)

Opening (Warm-up — 2–3 minutes)

Build rapport before diving into the topic.

1. Can you tell me a little about yourself and your role here at the institution?
 2. How long have you been studying/working here?
 3. How many classes do you typically attend/teach per week?
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Section 1: Current Experience with Attendance

Understand what they actually do today — not what they think they should do.

4. Can you walk me through what happens with attendance in a typical class — from start to finish?
 5. Who is responsible for taking attendance, and how is it done?
 6. How is that attendance record stored or submitted after class?
 7. How do you find out whether a student's attendance has been recorded correctly?
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Section 2: Pain Points and Frustrations

Surface the real problems — listen for emotion and repetition.

8. What is the most frustrating part of the current attendance process for you?
 9. Has there ever been a situation where attendance was recorded incorrectly? What happened?
 10. How much time would you estimate is spent on attendance-related tasks per class? Per semester?
 11. Have you ever had a dispute about attendance records? How was it resolved — or not resolved?
 12. What happens when a student misses the register or a lecturer forgets to take attendance?
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Section 3: Workarounds and Adaptations

Find out what people already do to cope — these reveal unmet needs.

13. Have you ever had to find a workaround for an attendance problem? What did you do?
 14. Do you use any tools, apps, or methods outside of the official system to track or verify attendance?
 15. If you could change one thing about how attendance is handled right now, what would it be?
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Section 4: Needs and Motivations

Go deeper into what they actually care about.

16. What does a "good" attendance system look like to you — what would it do?
 17. How important is it to you that attendance records are accurate? Why?
 18. Who else is affected when attendance isn't tracked properly? In what way?
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Section 5: Technology and Openness to Change

Gauge readiness and preferences without leading them.

19. How comfortable are you with using technology in the classroom/admin process?
 20. Have you seen or heard of any attendance systems used elsewhere that you found interesting?
 21. What concerns, if any, would you have about a new attendance system being introduced?
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Closing

22. Is there anything else about attendance tracking that you think is important and that we haven't covered?
 23. Do you know anyone else — a student, lecturer, or staff member — who has strong opinions about this topic that we could speak to?
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Interviewer Notes

Key quotes to remember:

Observed emotions/reactions:

Surprises or unexpected responses:

Follow-up needed: